The Ultimate Guide to Cooking Pasta

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1. Always use a large pot with plenty of water (at least 4-5 quarts per pound).
2. Generously salt the boiling water until it tastes like the sea.
3. Bring to a rolling boil before adding pasta.
4. Cook until al dente: tender with a slight firmness to the bite.
5. Reserve one cup of starchy pasta water before draining.
6. Emulsify the sauce with pasta water and butter or olive oil for a glossy finish.